

James Praise

WP Engine — Senior Principal, Product Marketing (AI & Emerging Products)

I'm reaching out as someone who has spent the last several years building exactly the kind of product marketing, GTM, and growth systems that teams like yours eventually need to scale with confidence.

My name is James. I'm a product marketing and growth operator with 7+ years of hands-on experience across B2B and SaaS companies in Africa, North America, and Europe, often as the first or early marketing hire, building clarity and structure where little existed. Across that work, I've contributed to over \$10M in qualified pipeline and supported more than 15 product launches, repositioning products, fixing broken funnels, and designing GTM motions for categories that didn't fully exist yet. I'm sharing this as context for how I think: WP Engine is an established, trusted company, but the AI and emerging products portfolio is a category the market doesn't have fixed language for yet.

I'm drawn to work that compounds, roles where ownership and long-term thinking matter more than surface-level output. That's part of why I started Marketing In Action, a newsletter documenting real product marketing systems rather than theory.

I do my best work at the intersection of product, marketing, and growth. In WP Engine's context, that means:

- Building the category's actual vocabulary first, since buyers can't evaluate what they don't yet have language for. At Hank Robotics, I built positioning, messaging, and ICP playbooks from scratch for a pre-commercialization category with zero existing market narrative, driving nearly 1,900% MQL growth in 3 months.
- Repositioning a product for an audience whose mental model of the category was still forming. At Reform, that meant a 34% lift in trial activation and 19% more decision-stage leads from competitor pages.
- Owning launch strategy end to end rather than handing it off after messaging is done. Reform's Feature Launch Plan Framework, priority matrix and channel mapping included, drove a 26% new feature adoption lift in 90 days.
- Launching an entirely new brand from zero when the existing narrative couldn't stretch to cover it. I led GrowthNode.ai's launch at FunnelEnvy myself, building the positioning and the full go-to-market plan before the brand had a single customer.

I care more about building systems that hold up as products and teams scale than about running isolated campaigns.

In several roles, I've been responsible for building marketing functions from zero: defining priorities, choosing tools, setting cadence, and deciding what not to do. I'm most effective in environments where marketing is expected to shape direction, not just execute requests, comfortable building strategy from the ground up in ambiguity rather than off an existing playbook.

I invest heavily in continuous learning. I completed an MBA in Entrepreneurship and Innovation at Miva Open University, hold a Product Marketing certification, and build my own AI-native tooling (Claude Code, n8n, MCP) as part of daily work: github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills.

One thing to flag directly: I'm based in Lagos, Nigeria, and the posting is scoped to work authorization in the United Kingdom. I wanted to raise that upfront rather than have it surface as a surprise later in the process, and I'm glad to talk through what a workable arrangement might look like if the fit is otherwise strong.

I put together a category-positioning brief that pulls WP Engine's own Four-Problem Framework out of a conference keynote microsite and makes it the front door of the AI story.

Thank you for taking the time to read this.

James

P.S. I've created a portfolio focused on this role at jamespraise.xyz/work/wp-engine.